Block 2: modify files and see changes

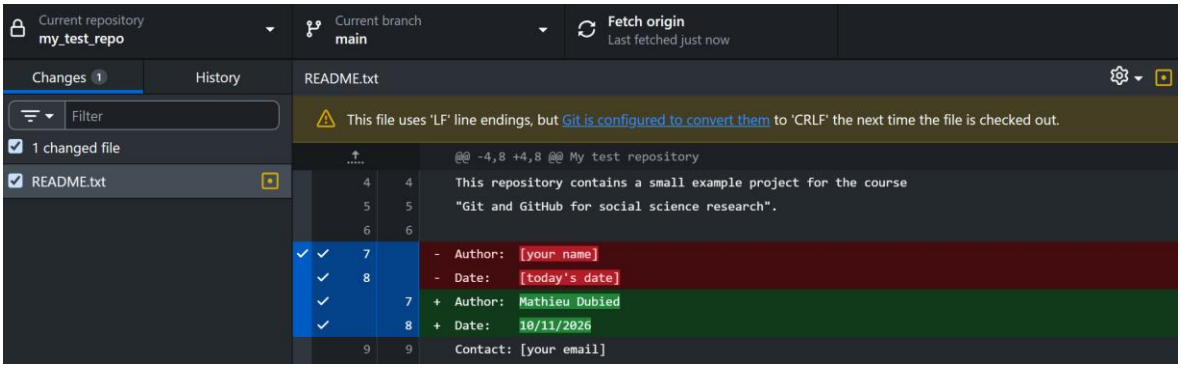
Part I: Modify files and commit changes

Step 1. Edit a file

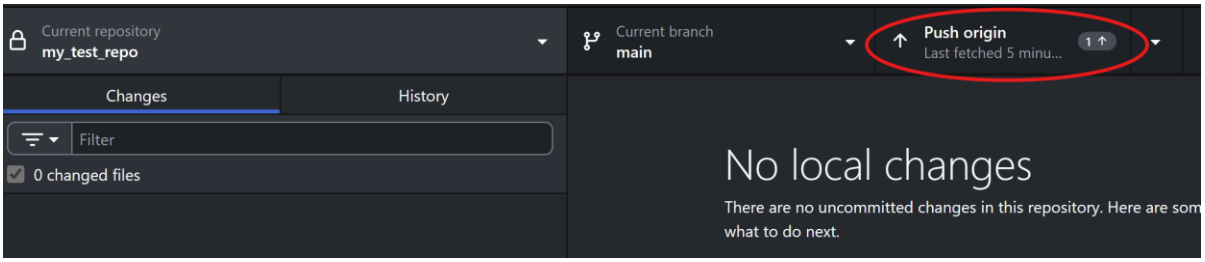
- Open `README.txt` in your `my_test_repo` folder with a text editor (e.g., Notepad on Windows, TextEdit on Mac)
- Replace "[your name]" and "[today's date]" with your name and today's name (keep [your email] untouched for now), and save (Ctrl+S / Cmd+S)

Step 2. Add, commit, and push

- Go back to GitHub Desktop: `README.txt` appears in the “Changes” tab. The orange symbol in the "Changes" tab means that the file has been modified (in comparison to the green "+" symbol that is used for new files that were added). The lines you removed are in red, the lines you added are in green



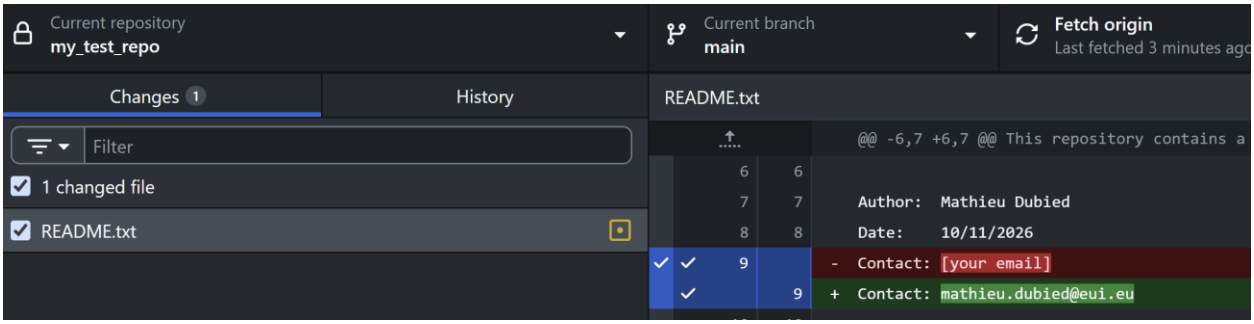
- Write a summary (e.g., “Add name and dates”) and click “Commit 1 file to main” (bottom left)
- Click “Push origin”



With "commit", you took another snapshot of your project, meaning that you saved a specific version of your files. With "push origin", you sent these changes online, on the GitHub platform. It means that your snapshot is not only saved on your computer, but also online. It is still private, as this is the setting we chose for this project (called a "repository" or "repo").

Step 3. Make a second edit

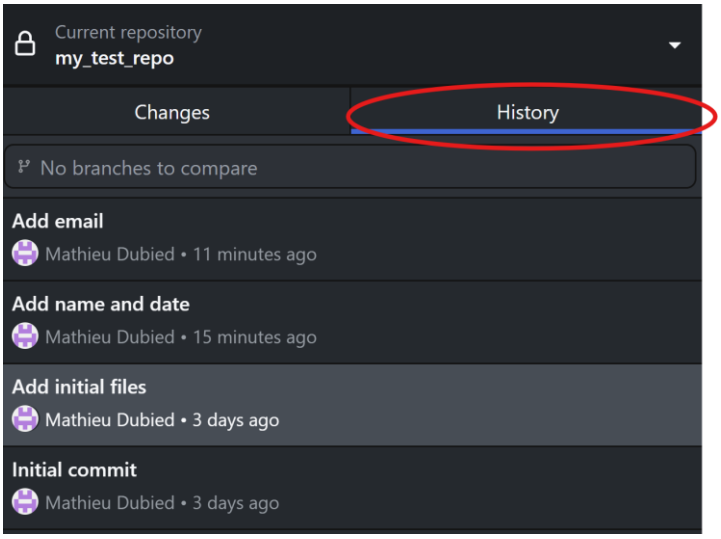
In README.txt, replace "[your email]" by your email address. As in step 2, go back to GitHub Desktop, add a summary (e.g., "Add email"), commit, and push origin.



Part II: See changes on GitHub

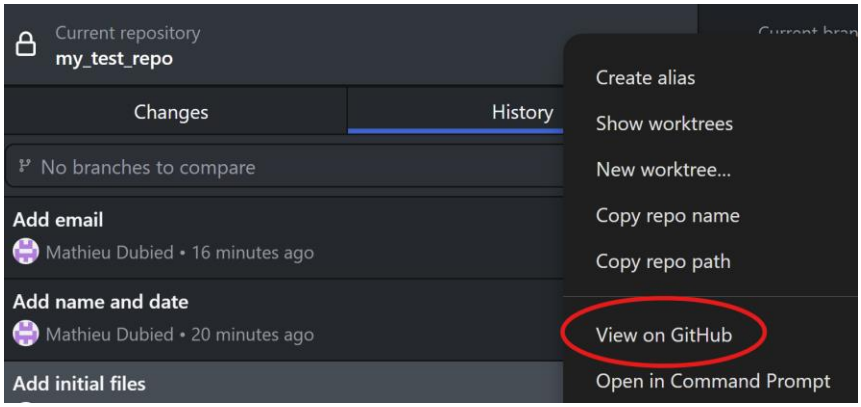
Step 4. In GitHub Desktop

- Click on the “History” tab (top left)
- Click on a commit to see which files changed and what changed in each file

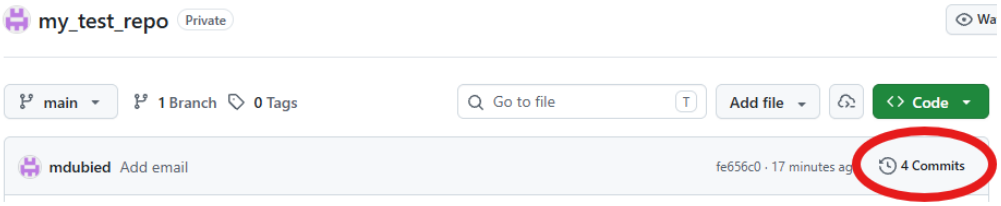


Step 5. On GitHub web

- In GitHub Desktop, right-click on "Current repository" and click "View on GitHub" (or open https://github.com/{your_username}/my_test_repo)

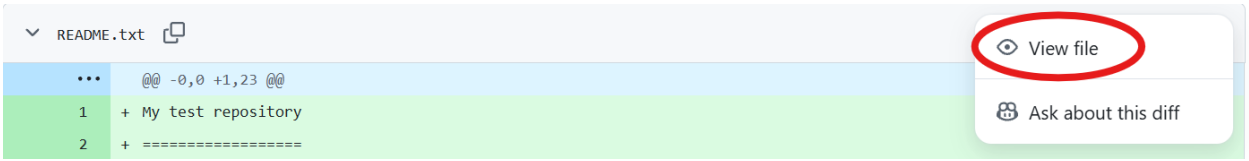


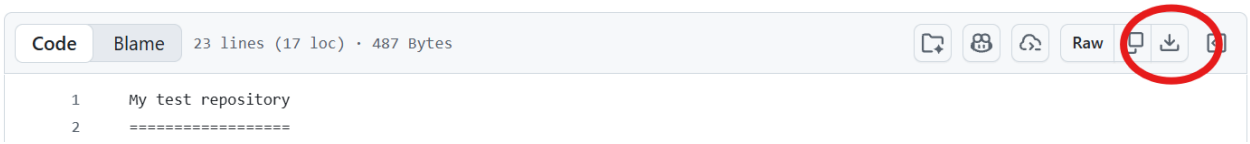
- Check that your files and your latest changes are there
- Click on “Commits” (top right of the file list) to see the list of commits



- Click on a commit to see what changed

Clicking on view file allows you to download a previous version of the file, for example the initial version if you want to recover it





Your notes: